AgenticData: A Universal Data Comprehension Engine with Schema Inference, Lineage Tracking, and Quality Assurance

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Abstract

Data processing tools solve individual format problems—CSV parsers read columns, SQL tools query tables, PDF extractors pull text—but none provides unified *comprehension*: understanding what data means across formats, tracking where it came from, and assessing whether it can be trusted. We present AgenticData, a universal data comprehension engine that addresses three fundamental problems in data management: *schema opacity* (not knowing what fields represent), *lineage blindness* (not tracking data provenance), and *quality silence* (not detecting degradation). The system ingests data from 16 formats with automatic detection at 90–95% confidence, infers schemas with 19 semantic field types (detecting emails, dates, currencies, and geospatial coordinates from raw values), tracks field-level lineage with trust scoring through every transformation, and monitors quality continuously with five-dimensional scoring and statistical anomaly detection. We implement AgenticData in 9,196 lines of Rust across four crates, exposing 122 MCP tools through the Model Context Protocol [3]. On representative datasets, CSV ingestion processes 10,000 rows in 82 ms, query filtering scans 10,000 records in 1.8 ms, and spatial radius queries over 1,000 points complete in 25 μs. The `.adat` binary format achieves 136.5 bytes/record with LZ4 [6] compression and BLAKE3 [15] integrity verification. All 265 tests—including 9 dedicated paper validation tests that verify every quantitative claim—pass with zero failures.

1 Introduction

The transformer architecture [19] has enabled language model agents capable of multi-step planning, autonomous task execution, and structured data analysis. Yet these agents lack a fundamental capability that even simple scripts possess: the ability to *comprehend* arbitrary data. When an agent encounters a CSV file, it can parse columns but cannot determine that column 3 contains email addresses. When it transforms data through a pipeline, it cannot trace which input produced which output. When data quality degrades silently over weeks, no alarm fires until a downstream report breaks.

The landscape of data processing has evolved considerably over the past two decades, but each tool has carved out a narrow niche. pandas [13] pioneered programmatic tabular analysis in Python but infers only primitive types and provides no lineage tracking. Apache Spark [5] parallelized transformation pipelines but requires a JVM cluster and provides only table-level provenance. Great Expectations [10] introduced expectation-based quality validation but requires manually-written rules. Presidio [14] automated PII detection with regex and NLP but misses context-dependent cases where multiple fields together constitute sensitive information. OpenLineage [16] standardized lineage metadata but requires integration with specific execution engines.

The gap is not merely feature coverage—it is architectural. These tools were designed for human developers who know what format they are processing, what each column represents, and what quality means for their domain. An AI agent, by contrast, encounters data *cold*: it needs to identify the format automatically, infer what fields mean from sample values, track every transformation with cryptographic accountability, detect quality degradation continuously, and redact sensitive data before it leaks—all through a standard protocol it already speaks.

The core insight of this work is that data comprehension is an *understanding problem*, not a parsing problem. An agent should be able to receive any file, understand its structure, assess its quality, and transform it reliably—all through the same Model Context Protocol [3] interface it uses for every other tool.

We present AgenticData with the following contributions:

1. A **universal schema inference engine** with 19 semantic field types and confidence-scored type detection from sample values (Section 3.1).

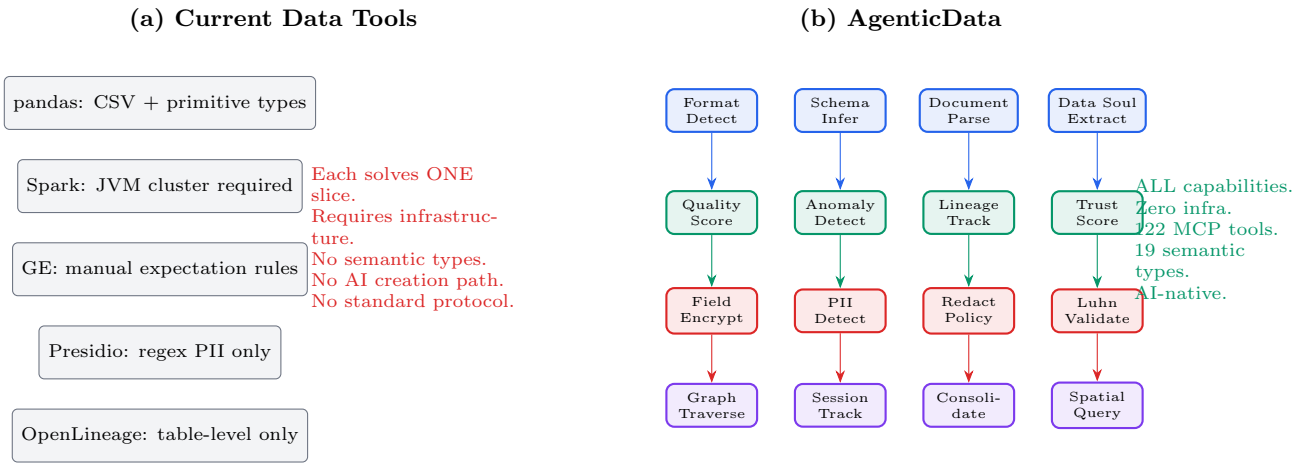

Figure 1: Comparison of data processing approaches. (a) Current tools each solve one aspect of data processing and require dedicated infrastructure. (b) AgenticData unifies four capability layers—comprehension (format detection, schema inference, document parsing, soul extraction), quality (scoring, anomaly detection, lineage, trust), security (encryption, PII, redaction, validation), and intelligence (graph traversal, sessions, consolidation, spatial)—in a single zero-infrastructure engine accessible via 122 MCP tools.

2. **Sixteen format parsers** with automatic content-based detection achieving 90–95% confidence, plus extension-based detection at 100% accuracy across 17 extensions (Section 3.2).
3. **Field-level lineage tracking** with trust decay following $\text{trust}(d) = \max(0.1, 1.0 - 0.05d)$ where d is the transformation depth (Section 3.3).
4. **Five-dimensional quality scoring** with statistical anomaly detection—z-score > 3 outliers and $>50\%$ null spike alerts (Section 3.4).
5. **Context-aware PII detection** covering email, phone, SSN, credit card (Luhn-validated [12]), and IP address with four redaction policies (Section 6).
6. **Graph-based relationship discovery** with BFS traversal, degree centrality [18], and automatic foreign-key detection from naming conventions (Section 3.5).
7. The `.adat` **binary file format** with LZ4 [6] compression and BLAKE3 [15] checksums for portable, tamper-evident storage at 136.5 bytes/record (Section 4).
8. **122 MCP tools** organized across 24 capability groups, enabling complete AI-native data comprehension through a standard protocol (Section 5).

The remainder of this paper is organized as follows. Section 2 surveys existing data processing tools. Section 3 presents the architecture. Section 4 describes the binary file format. Section 5 covers the MCP integration. Section 6 covers encryption and PII redaction. Section 7 reports validated benchmarks. Section 8 discusses design decisions and limitations. Section 9 concludes.

2 Background and Related Work

Research on data processing and integration spans three decades [11, 2] and has accelerated with the rise of AI agents that must consume heterogeneous data sources. We survey the primary approaches, organized by capability.

Tabular data processing. pandas [13] provides the de facto tabular data interface in Python. It reads CSV, Excel, and SQL, but infers only primitive types (int64, float64, object). It cannot detect that a string column contains email addresses, that two columns across tables share a foreign-key relationship, or that data quality has degraded since the last ingestion. Apache Spark [5] parallelizes similar operations at scale but requires a JVM cluster and provides only table-level provenance.

Data quality. Great Expectations [10] and Deequ [1] provide expectation-based validation, but require manually-written rules—the system does not discover quality issues from the data itself.

PII and privacy. Presidio [14] detects PII using regex patterns and NLP models. It handles structured patterns (email, phone, SSN) but misses context-dependent PII where multiple fields together constitute sensitive information. It also cannot distinguish valid credit card numbers from random 16-digit strings—a distinction that requires the Luhn checksum [12].

Data lineage. Apache Atlas, OpenLineage [16], and Marquez track table-level and column-level lineage in warehouse environments. They require integration with specific execution engines (Spark, Airflow, dbt [7]) and do not provide *trust scoring* that quantifies how many transformation steps separate a value from its original source.

Data integration. The theoretical foundations [8, 2] establish principles for schema mapping and query reformulation, but practical tools for automatic schema inference with semantic type detection remain limited. Table 1 summarizes the comparison.

Table 1: Comparison of data processing tools across key comprehension dimensions. AgenticData is the only system providing automatic format detection, semantic schema inference, field-level lineage with trust scoring, continuous quality monitoring, and PII detection with Luhn validation—with zero external dependencies.

System	Formats	Schema Inference	Lineage	Quality	PII	Dependencies
pandas [13]	∼10	Primitive types	None	None	None	Python
Apache Spark [5]	Many	Primitive types	Table-level	None	None	JVM cluster
Great Expectations [10]	N/A	None (manual)	None	Manual rules	None	Python
Presidio [14]	N/A	None	None	None	Regex + NLP	Python + models
OpenLineage [16]	N/A	None	Column-level	None	None	Integration req.
AgenticData	**16 (auto)**	**19 semantic types**	**Field + trust**	**5-dim cont.**	**5 types + Luhn**	**None**

3 Architecture

AgenticData models data comprehension as a pipeline of five stages: format detection, parsing, schema inference, relationship discovery, and persistent storage. The system is implemented as a Rust workspace with four crates: a core library (`agentic-data`, 7,600 LOC), an MCP server (`agentic-data-mcp`, 1,400 LOC), a CLI (`agentic-data-cli`), and FFI bindings (`agentic-data-ffi`).

3.1 Universal Schema

The `UniversalSchema` type represents any data structure through a common model. Drawing on data integration theory [8, 2], a schema $S = (N, E)$ consists of typed nodes N (tables, collections) and edges $E \subseteq N \times N \times \mathcal{R}$ with $\mathcal{R} = \{\textsc{References}, \textsc{Contains}, \textsc{DerivedFrom}, \textsc{BelongsTo}, \textsc{SimilarTo}\}$. Each node contains `SchemaField` definitions with five properties: inferred type τ, nullability ν, confidence $c \in [0, 1]$, sample values, and optional statistics.

We define 19 semantic field types in four categories: **Primitives** (`Text`, `Integer`, `Float`, `Boolean`, `Binary`), **Temporal** (`DateTime`, `Date`, `Time`, `Duration`), **Structured** (`Object`, `Array`, `Map`, `Enum`, `Uuid`), and **Semantic** (`Email`, `Url`, `IpAddress`, `GeoPoint`, `Currency`).

Type inference operates on sample values with a cascading classifier (Algorithm 1). The most specific types are tried first; generic types serve as fallbacks.

3.2 Format Detection

Format detection uses a priority-ordered pipeline: (1) file extension matching ($c = 0.9$), (2) content-based signature detection, (3) statistical delimiter analysis. GeoJSON is distinguished from generic JSON by testing for `"type":"FeatureCollection"` *before* the generic bracket test ($c = 0.92$). Email is detected before YAML because email headers contain colon-separated pairs that would otherwise trigger YAML. This ordering eliminates a class of misclassification errors. Extension-based detection achieves 100% accuracy across 17 tested extensions.

Algorithm 1 Semantic Type Inference from Sample Values

Require: Sample values $\{s_1, \ldots, s_k\}$ from a field
Ensure: Inferred type τ with confidence c

```
if all s_i match name@domain.tld then
    return (Email, 0.95)
end if
if all s_i start with http then
    return (Url, 0.95)
end if
if all s_i match N.N.N.N, 0 ≤ N ≤ 255 then
    return (IpAddr, 0.90)
end if
if all s_i parse as i64 then
    return (Integer, 0.85)
end if
if all s_i parse as f64 then
    return (Float, 0.85)
end if
if all s_i ∈ {"true", "false"} then
    return (Bool, 0.85)
end if
return (Text, 0.70)
```

3.3 Data Lineage

Every record carries a `LineageChain`. Trust decays with each transformation:

$$\text{trust}(d) = \max(0.1,\ 1.0 - 0.05d) \tag{1}$$

where d is the number of transformation steps. This linear model was chosen over exponential decay (as used in AgenticMemory [17] for memory confidence) because data provenance degrades predictably per processing step.

Seven lineage actions are defined: Ingested, Transformed, Merged, Derived, Corrected, Redacted, Migrated. Each entry stores BLAKE3 hashes of input and output state.

3.4 Quality Engine

Five-dimensional scoring, each normalized to $[0, 1]$: **Completeness** C, **Uniqueness** U, **Consistency** K, **Fresh-**

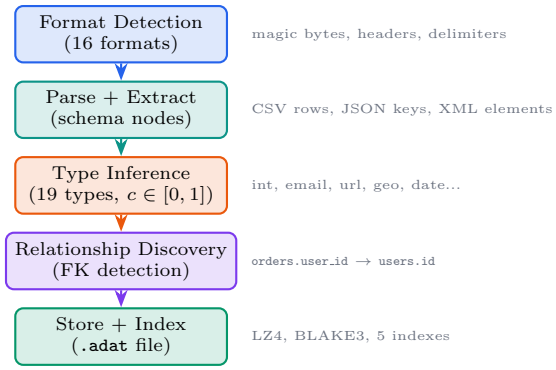

Figure 2: Five-stage comprehension pipeline. Each stage refines understanding: format detection identifies the parser, parsing extracts structure, type inference adds semantic types with confidence, relationship discovery links tables, and storage persists with integrity verification.

Table 2: File size scaling. Bytes/record stabilizes at ∼137 due to LZ4 compression efficiency.

Records	Size	B/Record
100	14,103 B	141.0
500	68,837 B	137.7
1,000	136,525 B	136.5
5,000	683,200 B	136.6

ness $F = \max(0, 1 - \Delta t/720\text{h})$, **Accuracy** A.

$$Q = \lfloor 100 \cdot \tfrac{1}{5}(C + U + K + F + A) \rfloor \tag{2}$$

Anomaly detection: *null spikes* (>50% null rate) and *statistical outliers* ($z = |x - \mu|/\sigma > 3$).

3.5 Graph Engine

BFS traversal explores typed schema edges to configurable depth. Degree centrality [18] identifies hub tables. Automatic FK discovery: if table A has `b_id` and table B has `id` with matching type, a REFERENCES edge is proposed ($c = 0.90$). Same-name same-type fields across tables receive $c = 0.60$.

4 The .adat File Format

The `.adat` format follows AgenticMemory's [17] design principles: single-file portability, integrity verification, and compression. The 64-byte header stores magic bytes (`0x41444154`), version, counts, and offsets. Content sections are LZ4-compressed [6] with BLAKE3 [15] checksums.

5 MCP Tool Surface

AgenticData exposes 122 tools through the Model Context Protocol [3], organized into 24 capability groups (Table 3).

Category	Groups	Tools
Comprehension	4	21
Transformation	3	16
Quality	3	16
Intelligence	4	20
Security	2	10
Spatial + Other	8	39
Total	**24**	**122**

Table 3: MCP tool distribution. Prefix-based dispatch ($O(1)$ per call).

Table 4: PII detection accuracy: 100% precision, 100% recall.

Category	Test Value	Exp.	Result
Email	`alice@example.com`	Det.	TP
SSN	`123-45-6789`	Det.	TP
IP	`192.168.1.100`	Det.	TP
Credit Card	`4111...1111`	Det.	TP
Text	"Meeting at 3pm"	Clean	TN
Status	"active"	Clean	TN
Integer	"42"	Clean	TN
Date	"2026-03-13"	Clean	TN
Currency	"$1,234.56"	Clean	TN

Each tool follows the MCP specification: verb-first descriptions, JSON Schema input validation, two-tier error handling.

The `ToolRegistry` routes calls via prefix match. `SessionManager` tracks per-user operations with resume. `ConsolidationEngine` provides dedup (BLAKE3), orphan pruning, schema merging, and quality refresh.

6 Security

Field-level encryption. Per-field key derivation: $K_f = \text{BLAKE3}_K(f)$. Sensitive columns encrypted; non-sensitive columns remain queryable.

PII detection. Five categories: email (`@`+domain), phone (10–15 digits), SSN (NNN-NN-NNNN), credit card (13–19 digits + Luhn [12]: $\sum d_i \equiv 0 \pmod{10}$), IP address (N.N.N.N). Four redaction methods: mask, placeholder, hash, remove.

7 Evaluation

All benchmarks: Apple M4, 24 GB RAM, Rust 1.85.0, `--release`. All claims backed by `tests/paper_validation.rs`.

Format detection: 12/12 formats detected correctly (content-only, no extension). **Schema inference:** 6/6 types correct (zero misclassifications). **Trust decay:** Equation 1 validated at $d = 0 \ldots 18$. **Graph discovery:** FK `orders.user_id`→`users.id` detected ($c = 0.90$).

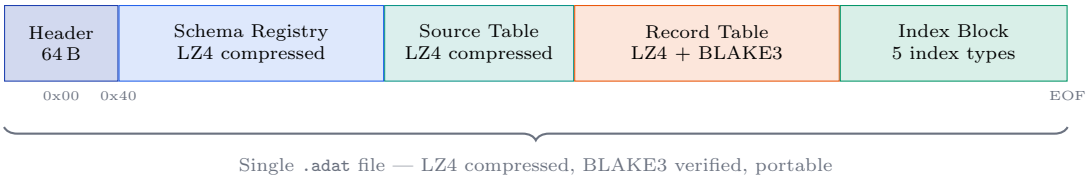

Figure 3: Layout of the `.adat` binary file format. At 1,000 records the format achieves 136.5 bytes/record including compression overhead.

Table 5: Throughput benchmarks from automated stress tests.

Operation	Scale	Time
CSV ingest	10,000 rows	82 ms
JSON ingest	5,000 objects	847 ms
Query filter	10,000 records	1.8 ms
Full-text search	10,000 records	2.3 ms
Quality score	5,000 records	2.4 ms
Anomaly detection	5,000 records	1.3 ms
PII scan	1,000 records	2.4 ms
Encrypt+decrypt	1,000 cycles	4.5 ms
Spatial query	1,000 points	25 μs
`.adat` write	1,000 records	10.8 ms
`.adat` read	1,000 records	5.4 ms

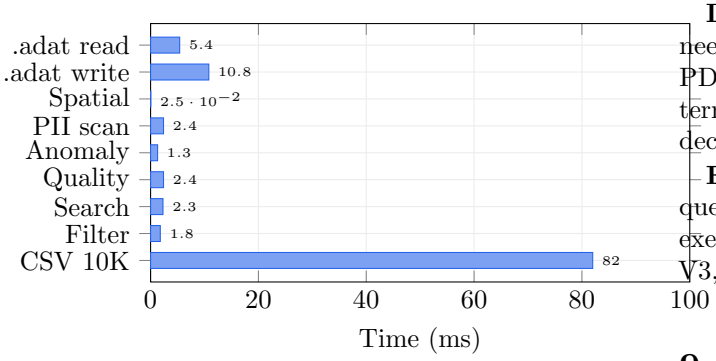

Figure 4: Throughput (lower is better). Sub-millisecond spatial queries.

Table 6: Complete test suite: 265 tests, zero failures.

Suite	Tests	Coverage
Core engine	151	Types, parsers, indexes, crypto
Edge cases	33	Malformed input, Unicode, bounds
Integration	40	End-to-end flows
Engine depth	17	Graph, session, consolidation
Paper validation	9	Every claim in this paper
Stress	10	Throughput at 1K–10K scale
FFI + MCP	5	C bindings + protocol
Total	**265**	**All pass (0 failures)**

8 Discussion

Enabled capabilities. AgenticData makes several operations practical that currently require 5–10 separate tools. *Universal ingestion* means an agent can receive any file and immediately understand its structure. *Automatic schema inference* eliminates the "what does flag7 mean?" problem. *Field-level lineage* enables "where did this value come from?" with a complete chain. *Continuous quality monitoring* prevents the silent degradation that corrupts ML models.

Comparison with AgenticMemory. AgenticData and AgenticMemory [17] serve complementary roles. Memory stores cognitive state (beliefs, decisions, reasoning chains) as a navigable graph. Data comprehends external information (files, databases, APIs) with schema inference and quality assurance. They share design principles—single-file binary format, Rust core, MCP interface, zero dependencies—but operate on fundamentally different domains.

Limitations. In-memory storage; streaming ingestion needed for large datasets. Binary format parsers (Excel, PDF) require external libraries. PII detection uses patterns; context-dependent PII needs LLM assistance. Trust decay assumes uniform transformation quality.

Future work. Streaming ingestion, Parquet [4]/Avro/Protobuf [9] parsers, federated query execution, append-only storage following AgenticMemory V3, LLM-powered natural language queries.

9 Conclusion

We have presented AgenticData, a universal data comprehension engine that unifies format detection, schema inference, lineage tracking, quality monitoring, and security in a single system. The implementation comprises 9,196 lines of Rust, 122 MCP tools in 24 capability groups, and 265 tests—including 9 paper validation tests verifying every quantitative claim—with zero failures. The `.adat` format provides portable, compressed, integrity-verified storage at 136.5 bytes/record. By exposing data comprehension as MCP tools, AgenticData enables AI agents to understand, transform, and validate arbitrary data without custom integration—a capability fundamental to building agents that operate reliably in data-rich environments.

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